

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



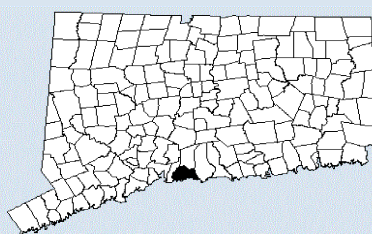
Branford School District

Christopher Tranberg, Superintendent • 203-488-7276 • <http://www.branfordschools.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	8
Enrollment	2,625
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$23,954
Total Expenditures ¹	\$65,225,731

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,376	52.4	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	175	6.7	5.2
Black or African American	111	4.2	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	447	17.0	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	148	5.6	4.7
White	1,735	66.1	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	195	7.4	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	967	36.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	366	13.9	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	179	13.8	82	5.8
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	11	9.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	84	20.9	39	8.4
White	211	12.8	69	3.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	27	13.2	12	5.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	196	21.6	80	7.7
Students with Disabilities	74	20.3	43	9.8
District	348	14.0	129	4.8
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 474

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	203.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	66.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	32.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	80.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	5.8
School Level	10.3
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	5.0
Support Staff	3.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	27.8
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	21.0
School Nurses	8.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	206.4

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.7	1.4
Black or African American	3	1.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	8	2.6	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.3	0.3
White	292	95.4	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	22.4	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	12	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	27	93.1	25	92.6
White	126	96.2	147	98.7
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	65	98.5	67	94.4
Students with Disabilities	21	91.3	26	92.9
District	186	95.9	211	97.7
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disability	20	55.6
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	71	59.7
Other Health Impairment	54	76.1
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	33	80.5
District	198	58.4
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	52	2.0	2.6
Emotional Disability	36	1.4	1.1
Intellectual Disability	9	0.3	0.6
Learning Disability	119	4.6	6.4
Other Health Impairment	71	2.8	3.5
Other Disabilities	21	0.8	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	50	1.9	2.0
All Disabilities	358	13.9	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	16	4.5	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	14	3.9	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$36,247,020	\$13,311	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$5,733,655	\$2,169	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$4,883,644	\$1,847	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$2,109,369	\$798	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$3,004,156	\$1,136	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$1,944,938	\$736	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$6,259,403	\$2,367	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$3,763,551	\$1,402	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$1,279,997	\$484	\$213
Total	\$65,225,731	\$23,954	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$4,339,723	33.3	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,700,594	13.1	10.2
Other Salaries	\$437,122	3.4	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$1,979,405	15.2	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$691,480	5.3	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,935,967	22.6	22.2
Supplies	\$92,532	0.7	0.7
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$832,914	6.4	8.4
Equipment	\$8,576	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$500	0.0	0.1
Total	\$13,018,814	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		20.0	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	88.1
State	7.1
Federal	4.7
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	81	72.6	80	76.1	36	71.2
Black or African American	66	58.7	65	55.2	36	53.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	209	62.6	207	58.7	83	60.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	73	69.8	72	67.2	37	63.1
White	866	68.6	862	66.1	387	63.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	143	64.9	140	64.2	50	57.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,157	67.8	1,150	65.2	530	63.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	463	61.2	460	58.4	185	55.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	837	70.9	830	68.7	395	66.1
Students with Disabilities	195	47.6	190	43.7	92	45.2
Students without Disabilities	1,105	70.9	1,100	68.8	488	66.0
High Needs	608	60.1	599	57.6	245	54.4
Non-High Needs	692	73.9	691	71.6	335	68.7
District	1,300	67.4	1,290	65.1	580	62.7

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	86.0	74.1	71.9	87.7	699	79.5
Curl Up	78.9	81.0	88.4	96.2	691	86.0
Push Up	76.6	74.7	81.1	78.7	690	77.8
Mile Run/PACER	73.1	65.5	62.4	56.2	677	64.5
All Tests - District	53.2	42.1	46.2	54.6	669	48.7
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	6	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	36	86.1
White	151	95.4
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	6	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	81	88.9
Students with Disabilities	29	86.2
District	208	93.3
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	73	38.6
Male	102	46.6
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	15	26.8
White	127	45.4
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	44	32.1
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	175	42.7
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	84.4	94.7
Male	*	88.7
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60.6	*
White	80.8	93.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	63.0	88.1
Students with Disabilities	66.7	*
District	78.3	92.2
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	67.4	75	45.0	50	89.9	63.9
	High Needs Students	60.1	75	40.1	50	80.1	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	65.1	75	43.4	50	86.8	60.2
	High Needs Students	57.6	75	38.4	50	76.7	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	62.7	75	41.8	50	83.6	61.8
	High Needs Students	54.4	75	36.3	50	72.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	55.8%	100%	55.8	100	55.8	58.7%
	High Needs Students	52.5%	100%	52.5	100	52.5	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	59.2%	100%	59.2	100	59.2	61.4%
	High Needs Students	53.8%	100%	53.8	100	53.8	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	71.7%	100%	35.9	50	71.7	58.9%
	Oral	69.0%	100%	34.5	50	69.0	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	14.0%	<=5%	31.9	50	63.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	19.5%	<=5%	21.1	50	42.1	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	96.8%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	42.7%	75%	28.5	50	56.9	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		87.4%	94%	46.5	50	93.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		93.3%	94%	99.2	100	99.2	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		91.1%	94%	97.0	100	97.0	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		78.3%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		90.1% 48.7%	75%	32.5	50	65.0	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		60.3%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1093.1	1450	75.4	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	73.9	60.1	13.8	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	71.6	57.6	14.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	68.7	54.4	14.3	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	91.1%	2.9%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	98.6
Math	All Students	98.1
	High Needs Students	96.9
Science	All Students	96.7
	High Needs Students	94.7

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Branford Public Schools (BPS) has engaged all stakeholder groups in the creation of a strategic coherence plan. The plan contains three goals: (1) ensuring equal opportunity for growth and development for all Branford students, (2) aligning the key systems in the district to support the student acquisition of the Global Learning Competencies through the implementation of the Definition of Deep Learning, and (3) improving the processes and tools that the district uses to communicate and engage critical stakeholders across the district so they can be more meaningful partners in the support of student learning.

The District's guiding principles include continuous improvement, reflective practice, and growth mindset. To that end, the district leadership team developed strategy maps for various departments and grade bands. Strategy maps identify specific goals for students, teachers, and leaders, the new learning required to achieve such goals, and the evidence that will be collected to determine the extent to which the goal has been met. The leadership team will revise these maps for the coming school year to account for progress made thus far.

Action steps and strategies were developed to address each of the three goal areas in the strategic coherence plan. Focus groups met with the Superintendent and Assistant Superintendent this fall and winter. Groups included various stakeholders: parents, teachers and service providers, students, and paraeducators. These groups served as part of the Superintendent's entry plan and allowed the new leadership team to better understand the strengths and needs of the community. Information from focus groups was analyzed and themes emerged. These themes shaped the strategies and action steps that are now memorialized in the strategic plan.

There has been a concerted effort to improve communication between the school district and the community. Hive-Mind Headlines is the newly created Superintendent's newsletter, sent to all staff, parents, and caregivers. The newsletter recognizes recent accomplishments, celebrates ongoing improvement efforts, and highlights important information at the district level. A new website is also being developed. The website will make it easier for community members to access essential information about the district, personnel, and programs. Finally, ParentSquare is being adopted as an improved communication tool. The tool will ease communication between parents and educators and will streamline district level communication to families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

In 2023-24, 72 Branford students enrolled in magnet and charter schools, and 60 non-resident students attended district schools through the Open Choice program. The District ensured all students had transportation home for afterschool programs and activities.

Efforts to increase minority staff included outreach, recruitment, and collaboration with the area RESC. A diversity plan was approved by the Connecticut State Department of Education in June, with ongoing adjustments as needed.

The District remained committed to reducing racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. Teachers expanded library collections to reflect the diverse BPS student body and offered readers opportunities to explore diverse worlds. The District improved access to translation services and covered senior activity costs to ensure participation, with expenses for students in need covered at other grade levels as well.

Branford High School was designated a "No Place for Hate" school with the Anti-Defamation League, supporting BHS's goal of creating a community where all students feel a sense of belonging and engage in deeper learning. The curriculum included diverse cultures and histories, with events celebrating Hispanic and Latino Heritage Month, Black History Month, and Women's History Month. The evolving Program of Studies and special events engaged students and staff, fostering a global perspective with empathy and kindness.

At Walsh Intermediate School, students engaged in lessons on acceptance and inclusion. Hispanic heritage was integrated into the curriculum in September and October, concluding with an author visit from Luisana Duarte Armendariz. In January and February, students learned about black and brown cultures through history and music, supported by community outreach and Blues and Beyond resources.

Elementary schools offered programs to increase cultural awareness and arts appreciation. A new reading curriculum aimed to provide equitable content access and develop foundational reading skills. New math tools ensure equitable instructional experiences. Second graders participated in free swimming lessons through a partnership with Soundview YMCA. Water safety and basic swimming skills were emphasized for children in the shoreline community.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Branford School District's budget process ensures equity across schools and programs while addressing student needs. Principals, directors, and teacher leaders submit budget requests, which central office staff evaluate through the lens of equitable resource allocation and emerging district needs.

During the budget process, the District maintains ongoing communication and collaboration with school and department leaders to ensure equity across programs and levels. The District prioritizes reasonable class sizes, supports the strategic coherence plan, and addresses emerging needs, such as students' academic, social, and emotional learning; inclusion and education of students with disabilities; and support for students from diverse backgrounds. To enhance academic support, the District has begun increasing the number of interventionists in elementary schools, allowing tier two instruction to be delivered by these specialists instead of classroom teachers. Additionally, the BPS strategic plan aims to improve identification and support systems for gifted and talented students.